

5 Signs You're in Perimenopause

1

Your sleep is broken for no obvious reason

Falling oestrogen disrupts your sleep architecture — you wake at 2am, can't switch off, and feel exhausted despite time in bed. Try keeping your bedroom cool, avoiding alcohol in the evening, and building a consistent wind-down routine. Magnesium glycinate (200-400mg before bed) can also make a noticeable difference.

2

Your moods feel unpredictable and intense

Progesterone — your calming hormone — drops first in perimenopause, leaving oestrogen relatively dominant and your emotions harder to regulate. Reducing caffeine, stabilising blood sugar with balanced meals, and protecting your sleep are the three highest-leverage changes you can make.

3

You feel anxious but can't explain why

This is hormonal, not a personal failing. Your nervous system becomes more reactive when oestrogen fluctuates, triggering a low-level sense of dread or worry. Slow breathing, reducing stimulants, and magnesium glycinate before bed all help calm the nervous system response.

4

Your periods have changed — heavier, lighter, or irregular

Cycle changes are often the first visible sign of perimenopause. They can start up to 10 years before your last period. Start tracking your cycle now so you have accurate data to share with your doctor.

5

Brain fog and forgetfulness have crept in

Oestrogen supports memory, focus, and processing speed — so when it fluctuates, your brain feels the effects. Prioritising sleep, getting omega-3s from food or supplements, and reducing decision fatigue all help restore clarity.
